

The WSA and ESA Architectures

Objectives:

At the end of this episode, I will be able to:

1. Understand the major aspects of the WSA architecture
2. Understand the major aspects of the ESA architecture

Additional resources used during the episode can be obtained using the download link on the overview episode.

Remember the main topics of discussion in this episode:

Here are the steps of the WSA process:

- Step 1 – user initiates Web request
- Step 2 – firewall (DG) redirects to the WSA
- Step 3 – WSA checks request
- Step 4 – WSA initiates web request
- Step 5 – Web server replies to WSA
- Step 6 – WSA sends reply content to client

Here are the steps for the ESA with inbound email:

Inbound Email

- Step 1 – sender email to ronnie@acme123.com
- Step 2 – DNS resolves to ESA IP address as mail server
- Step 3 – email sent to ESA
- Step 4 – after inspection, email sent to email server
- Step 5 – email server sends to client

Here are the steps for the ESA for outbound mail:

Outbound Email

- Step 1 – employee sends email
 - Step 2 – email server sends to ESA
 - Step 3 – email inspected by ESA
 - Step 4 – ESA performs DNS lookup
 - Step 5 – ESA sends to recipient
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External Resources: